THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE DEFENSE THESIS

The Bottleneck Nobody Invited

Global military budgets have never been larger, and the order books of the companies meant to fill them have never been fuller. Yet on 4 September Reuters reported that several Chinese rare-earth suppliers had quietly stopped shipping to American customers, and the question that has hung over the rearmament trade since the summer sharpened into something concrete. The question is no longer whether governments will spend. It is whether the spending converts into delivered hardware — and who owns the inputs that decide.

That is a different trade from the one most portfolios put on in 2022. It rewards conversion, not appropriation.

A reframe worth holding onto

13D Research, reporting from the Defense Industrial Base Consortium conference in Philadelphia on 27 August, made an observation that reframes the sector. Roughly a third of the hundred companies present were miners. Not one mining executive was invited to speak.

13D's conclusion — a view, not a forecast — is that critical minerals are not one bottleneck among several in the defence supply chain. They are *the* bottleneck, and the US Department of War's $2bn minerals triage is, in the firm's phrase, "still in diapers."

Method. Internal material comes from the Heyokha research Wiki page *Defense* (created 23 June 2026, last reviewed 19 August 2026) and its source summaries — named providers' opinions, labelled as views, not verified fact. Every external figure was checked against public reporting and carries an as-of date. Where the two disagree, the disagreement is stated rather than reconciled. Prices are as of 7 September 2026 and move.

Picture a bakery holding firm orders for eighty thousand wedding cakes stretching five years out — the largest book in its history, every order signed. The owner hires, buys ovens, extends the building. Then she discovers that the only mill capable of grinding the hard flour her recipe requires is owned by the man competing against her for the same weddings. He has not refused to sell. He has simply started requiring a licence, granted to fifteen approved buyers, renewed annually, at his discretion. Her order book has not shrunk by a single cake. Her ability to bake them has changed completely. This is roughly where the Western defence industrial base now stands, and it explains why an industry with record backlogs has spent the past fortnight trading badly.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

$2.9tn

Global military spending in 2025 — a record, up 2.9%, the eleventh consecutive annual increase and 2.5% of world GDP, the highest since 2009. The US, China and Russia together took $1.48tn, 51% of it. — *SIPRI data as cited on the internal Defense page, 2 July 2026*

€80.5bn

Rheinmetall's order backlog at the end of H1 2026, against half-year sales of €5.23bn. In the same report the company trimmed full-year sales guidance by about €300m after Germany cancelled the F126 frigate programme. — *Rheinmetall half-year report, 6 August 2026*

80%

China's estimated share of global tungsten refining. It also processes around 90% of the world's rare earths and produces some 60% of global antimony. From December 2025, only fifteen Chinese firms were licensed to export tungsten for 2026–27. — *trade and industry reporting, as of September 2026*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Two weeks in which the story changed shape

The rearmament trade has run on a simple and, until recently, correct premise: budgets are going up, therefore defence revenues go up, therefore defence equities go up. The budget half of that chain remains intact and is if anything accelerating. NATO's members replaced the old 2%-of-GDP target with a 5% target for 2035 — 3.5% for core defence, 1.5% for defence-related infrastructure. European allies and Canada are expected to spend around $634bn in 2026, 2.53% of their combined GDP, lifting their share of alliance spending to 42.7% from 30.3% in 2021. Belgium raised its budget 59% in a single year; Spain by 50%.

The second half of the chain has begun to fray in public. On 6 August Rheinmetall reported half-year revenue of €5.23bn, up 39%, with the operating margin improving from 12.1% to 15.0% and a backlog of €80.5bn — and simultaneously narrowed its full-year sales guidance after the German government cancelled the F126 frigate order. Record book, smaller forecast. The market read the cash-flow line rather than the backlog line, and the shares have since drifted; Rheinmetall closed at €1,034.90 on 7 September, well below the €1,679 twelve-month consensus target that 21 analysts still carry.

Then came the input squeeze. On 4 September, Reuters reported that some Chinese rare-earth suppliers had halted shipments to the United States, apparently fearing domestic regulatory punishment for complying with Western due-diligence audits after Beijing sanctioned the Responsible Business Alliance in August. Chinese customs data show gallium exports down 65% and yttrium down 98% this year. Ammonium paratungstate, the intermediate from which tungsten metal is made, has traded above $3,000 per tonne in Rotterdam, up more than 200% since the start of the year. The United States has no active commercial tungsten mine. Rare-earth supply is now formally on the agenda for President Xi Jinping's visit to Washington on 24 September.

The sector tape has reflected the tension rather than the headlines. The iShares US Aerospace & Defense ETF closed at $225.61 on 7 September, roughly 12% below its 52-week high of $256.60 — in a year in which Lockheed Martin is up around 30% and global budgets set records. Internally, 13D's own Defense Index fell 6.0% in the week to 27 August and a further 5.0% in the week to 3 September, in the same issues in which the firm published its most structurally bullish case of the year.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A budget is an intention. A backlog is a promise. Neither is a delivered munition, and only the third one generates cash. The defence bull case of 2022 was a bet on the first two. The defence bull case of 2026 has to be a bet on the third — and the third is *not* currently constrained by money.

MECHANISM

Following one artillery shell through the economics

1 · Appropriation

A parliament votes the money. This step is now essentially unconstrained: NATO Europe and Canada at ~$634bn for 2026, US congressional approval above $1tn, a potential $1.5tn US budget discussed for 2027.

→

2 · Contract

The order enters a backlog. Rheinmetall's stands at €80.5bn. No revenue is recognised here. Backlog coverage of 2026 sales is 95%, so near-term revenue is largely already committed — and largely already known.

→

3 · Feedstock

The shell needs steel, propellant, explosive fill, a tungsten penetrator core, antimony in the primer. Producing 100,000 complete rounds a month requires roughly 66,000 tonnes of explosives. The refining sits largely in China.

→

4 · Delivery

Only on physical delivery does backlog become revenue and margin. A cancelled programme (F126) or an unavailable input removes the conversion without touching the order book — which is why backlog and guidance can move in opposite directions.

Flow constructed from Rheinmetall's H1 2026 half-year report (6 August 2026), NATO's July 2026 defence investment update, and US Army 155mm production reporting. Explosives-tonnage figure from published industry analysis of 100,000-round monthly output. Illustrative of the sequence, not of any single contract.

80%

of global tungsten refining capacity sits in China. Tungsten is the material of choice for armour-piercing penetrators and has no easy substitute at the required density.

+200%

rise in the Rotterdam price of ammonium paratungstate since the start of 2026, to above $3,000 per tonne, as export licensing tightened and military demand rose.

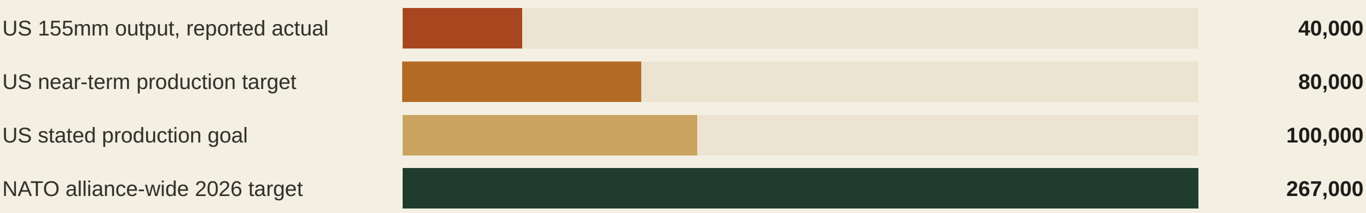
Zero

active commercial tungsten mines in the United States. Defence is estimated at about 12% of tungsten demand today, rising toward 15% in 2027–28 on stockpile rebuilding.

Figures from published trade and industry reporting as of September 2026. Share estimates for Chinese refining capacity vary between sources; the 80% figure is the most commonly cited and should be treated as approximate.

THE COMPARISON THE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

Ordnance output against ordnance targets



Rounds per month. US actual output of roughly 40,000 per month is the most recently reported figure and dates from August 2025; the 80,000 and 100,000 figures are stated targets, not achieved rates. NATO's 267,000 is an alliance-wide 2026 target. Bars are scaled to the largest value and are illustrative; the comparison mixes one reported actual with three targets, and is shown to convey the size of the gap rather than a like-for-like measurement.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Treat defence not as an order-taking business but as a conversion business — closer to a refinery than to a software vendor. The relevant question is not how much crude arrives at the gate. It is *throughput*: what fraction of the book becomes delivered product, at what margin, and which single input sets the ceiling.

THE SHIFT

What has actually changed

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
The binding constraint moved from money to materials	Record $2.9tn global spending in 2025 alongside APT tungsten above $3,000/t, up over 200% in 2026, and no US commercial tungsten mine	Scarcity supports pricing power for whoever holds supply — and compresses the deliverable volumes of everyone who does not
Backlog and guidance can now diverge	Rheinmetall's €80.5bn book alongside a roughly €300m cut to 2026 sales guidance after the F126 cancellation	Backlog gives multi-year visibility, but it also means near-term surprises come from conversion and cancellation, not from demand
The consensus on drones is being questioned from inside the bull camp	13D's 13 August note that most mass-produced drones "would not work in an intense EW environment," and that 20 drones on average are now needed to damage a tank	It opens counter-drone and directed-energy as a sector while warning that today's drone designs may be a dead end
Forward basing is being repriced as a liability	13D's estimate that permanent overseas basing costs perhaps ~$200bn a year against an official ~$30bn summary, with NSA Bahrain still incapacitated	It argues for long-range and unmanned systems spending, and against the fixed infrastructure and force posture that anchor several prime contractors
Procurement itself is contested	Anduril's "build first, sell later" model — a fighter aircraft announced to first flight in 18 months — against a prime base consolidated from 51 firms to 5 since 1993	Faster, cheaper capability is the point; it also threatens the incumbents whose backlogs the bull case rests on

BOTH SIDES

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The spending cycle is structural, not cyclical.** Eleven consecutive annual increases to a record $2.9tn in 2025, and a NATO target that rises to 5% of GDP by 2035 from 2% — a multi-decade appropriation floor rather than a spike.
- **Backlogs give unusual visibility.** Rheinmetall reports 95% backlog coverage of 2026 sales and a book-to-bill above three in Q2, with the book guided to €100–120bn by year-end.
- **Depletion forces replenishment.** 13D's 6 August note reports that virtually all of the US Army's long-range missile stockpile and half or more of Air Force stand-off ground-attack missiles were expended against Iran, with Navy Tomahawks below half of 2024 levels — a view, but one that implies years of restocking demand.
- **Scarcity accrues to someone.** If minerals are the bottleneck, the owners of Western processing capacity capture the rent. Rare-earth equities rose on the September shipment halts rather than falling.
- **Earnings are landing, and orders are diversifying.** Leidos raised full-year guidance on 4 August on record Q2 revenue of $4.6bn; Hanwha Aerospace carried a Land Systems backlog near KRW 39.7tn at Q1 2026 across Poland, Egypt, Australia, Norway and Finland.

The bear case

- **Budgets are already in the price.** The record-spending story has been public since 2022. ITA at $225.61 sits 12% below its 52-week high despite the best budget news in forty years, which suggests the market has moved on to the harder question.
- **Conversion is failing in plain sight.** Reported US 155mm output of roughly 40,000 rounds a month against a 100,000 goal and a 267,000 alliance target is not a rounding error. It is a factor of two to six.
- **The input is controlled by the adversary.** An industry whose penetrators need tungsten cannot plan around a licensing regime granted to fifteen firms at Beijing's discretion — and, as of 4 September, some suppliers are declining to ship at all.
- **Cancellation risk is live, and cash lags growth.** Germany's F126 cancellation cost Rheinmetall roughly €300m of 2026 guidance; coverage of the same quarter paired record growth with cash-flow concerns, as the capacity build absorbs what the profit-and-loss statement advertises.
- **The technology bet may be wrong.** This is the bear point the internal page makes best against itself: 13D warns that today's drone designs would fail in a contested electromagnetic environment, so "over-investment in existing drone designs may be a dead-end even if conflicts do not escalate."

The bear case above is not lifted from the Wiki. The internal Defense page has a bear-case heading with no text under it and a Contradictions section that reads, in full, "None yet — only 13D sources in the compilation window." The sceptical case here was therefore assembled from external reporting — the guidance cut, the output shortfall, the cash-flow commentary, the sector's position relative to its own 52-week high — and from the tensions inside the internal material itself, chiefly 13D's warning against the drone consensus that other parts of its own defence thesis rely upon.

WHERE THE VIEWS PART COMPANY

An unresolved disagreement

On 3 September, 13D added Leidos to its Defense Index on the strength of the company's unmanned surface vessel franchise, citing Q2 revenue of $4.56bn against $4.44bn consensus and adjusted EPS of $3.26 against $2.91. The company's own release supports the revenue figure and the guidance raise. It also shows adjusted EPS up 2% year on year and a book-to-bill of 1.1 for the quarter — solid, but a long way from the inflection that the sea-drone framing implies, and a different characterisation of the same quarter. Separately, 13D's Defense Index fell 6.0% and then 5.0% in the two weeks during which the firm published its strongest structural argument of the year. The internal view is that the market is mispricing a genuine industrial transition. The external tape's reading is that the market has understood the transition and is discounting the industry's ability to execute it. Both readings fit the same facts. This edition does not resolve them.

THE DASHBOARD

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Xi's Washington visit, 24 September	Rare-earth and critical-mineral supply is formally on the agenda	The single event most likely to loosen or harden the input constraint this quarter
Rotterdam APT price	Above $3,000/t and up more than 200% year-to-date	The cleanest live read on whether tungsten scarcity is easing or tightening
US monthly 155mm output	Roughly 40,000 rounds against an 80,000 near-term target	The most legible public measure of whether appropriation is converting into ordnance
Rheinmetall's Q3 book-to-bill and guidance	Backlog guided toward €100–120bn; guidance already trimmed once	Tests whether the F126 cut was idiosyncratic or the first of a series
NATO 3.5% core-defence compliance count	Five allies expected to meet it in 2026; seventeen meet the 1.5% related-investment guideline	Distinguishes genuine core procurement from infrastructure spending reclassified as defence
ITA against its 52-week high	$225.61 on 7 September, roughly 12% below $256.60	If budgets keep rising and this gap widens, the market is pricing conversion failure, not demand

EXPRESSION

Three postures, not one answer

Own the appropriation

The established primes, bought for budget growth and backlog visibility. The cost: this is the most crowded and best-understood version of the theme, it is where the guidance cuts land first, and it assumes an order book converts at historical rates when the evidence on ordnance output says it currently does not.

Own the bottleneck

Western mining and processing of tungsten, antimony and rare earths, on the view that the scarce input captures the rent. The cost: policy-dependent, capital-hungry and violently volatile — MP Materials has traded between $37.81 and $100.25 over the past year — and a single diplomatic thaw can halve the scarcity premium overnight.

Own the conversion layer

Autonomy software, secure communications, sensing and counter-drone systems — the kill chain rather than the platform. The cost: 13D's own warning applies here most sharply. If mass-produced drone designs fail in a contested electromagnetic environment, a good deal of what is being funded today is being funded for the wrong war.

The companies named below are illustrative of how the theme is expressed in listed markets. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing in this document is investment advice. No position, current or intended, is implied.

RHM

€1,034.90
7 Sep 2026

Rheinmetall AG · Frankfurt

The cleanest listed expression of European rearmament and, this quarter, the cleanest illustration of the conversion problem. H1 2026 revenue of €5.23bn was up 39% with the operating margin at 15.0%, and the backlog reached €80.5bn across vehicles, ammunition, digital systems, naval and air defence. In the same report, the F126 frigate cancellation removed roughly €300m from full-year sales guidance. 13D has separately flagged the company as antimony- and tungsten-intensive and a named target of Chinese sanctions.

WATCH NEXT

> Q3 backlog against the €100–120bn year-end guide, and whether free cash flow keeps pace with the capacity build.

LMT

$526.23
7 Sep 2026

Lockheed Martin · NYSE

The anchor prime, and up roughly 30% in 2026 — the appropriation trade working as intended. Lockheed sits on both sides of this edition's argument: it is the principal beneficiary of a $1tn-plus US budget, and it is the archetype of the cost structure 13D criticises, in which US precision stand-off weapons are described as costing many multiples of cheaper adversary munitions while taking far longer to produce. Consensus targets cluster near $633, with a range from $503 to $756 — an unusually wide spread for a company of this maturity.

WATCH NEXT

> Munitions and missile segment delivery volumes rather than bookings, and any commentary on mineral or energetics input availability.

LHX

52-wk $256–$379
as of Sep 2026

L3Harris Technologies · NYSE

The munitions-capacity and electronic-warfare story. The Aerojet Rocketdyne acquisition put solid rocket motors — a genuine physical chokepoint in Western missile production — inside a listed prime, which is precisely the constraint the depletion argument runs into. The shares have been weak, trading near the bottom of a 52-week range whose high is roughly 48% above recent levels, against a backdrop of a chief executive departure and execution questions. A capacity story in a sector where capacity is the scarce thing, priced as though it is not.

WATCH NEXT

> Solid rocket motor deliveries and any disclosed constraint on energetics or specialty-metal feedstock.

LDOS

Q2 rev $4.6bn
4 Aug 2026

Leidos Holdings · NYSE

Added to 13D's Defense Index on 3 September for its unmanned surface vessel franchise — Sea Hunter, Seahawk, Ranger, Mariner — as sea drones move to the centre of the US–China naval contest. Q2 revenue was a record $4.6bn, up 7%, with adjusted EBITDA margin of 13.8% and non-GAAP EPS of $3.26, up 2%. Full-year guidance was raised to $18.20–18.40bn of revenue. The quarter's book-to-bill was 1.1. This is where internal enthusiasm and the reported numbers sit least comfortably together.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether US Navy unmanned surface vessel awards accelerate ahead of the stated 2030 Indo-Pacific fielding ambition.

012450 KS

~$42bn mkt cap
as of Sep 2026

Hanwha Aerospace · KOSPI

South Korea's emergence as a top-tier arms exporter is a long-standing element of the internal thesis, and Hanwha is its clearest listed expression. Q1 2026 sales of KRW 5,751bn were up 5% with operating profit up 21%; Land Systems backlog stood near KRW 39.7tn including the Norway Chunmoo award, with a Finland K9 contract of about KRW 940bn expected to enter the Q2 book. The pattern is instructive: profit fell 31% in Land Systems on light first-quarter export deliveries. Even the share-gainer is a delivery-timing story.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether the promised second-half export deliveries to Poland, Egypt and Australia actually ship on schedule.

MP

$54.53
5 Sep 2026

MP Materials · NYSE

The bottleneck expressed directly: Mountain Pass in California, plus a rare-earth metal, alloy and magnet plant under construction in Fort Worth. Rare-earth equities rose in early September on the reports of halted Chinese shipments, which is the mechanism working as the bull case describes. The 52-week range of $37.81 to $100.25 is the cost of admission — this is a policy-driven security-of-supply premium, and premia of that kind compress as fast as they expand. Note also that rare earths are not tungsten; the magnet chokepoint and the penetrator chokepoint are different problems with different solutions.

WATCH NEXT

> Fort Worth commissioning milestones, and what emerges on minerals from the 24 September Washington meeting.

The bottom line

What was repriced over the past fortnight was not the defence budget. It was the conversion rate. Investors spent three years buying an appropriation cycle and are now being asked to underwrite an industrial one — a far harder thing to forecast, because it depends on refining capacity, energetics, specialty metals and export licences held largely outside the West. The sector trading 12% below its 52-week high in the best budget environment in four decades is not a contradiction. It is the market changing the question.

The evidence remains genuinely mixed. Record backlogs and eleven straight years of rising global spending are real, and so are a guidance cut, an ordnance output rate at a fraction of its target, and an input the principal adversary refines. The reasonable inference is that the theme has bifurcated: budget exposure has become the commodity part of the trade, and conversion capability — capacity, feedstock security, delivery — has become the scarce part. The next test is close and dated. On 24 September, rare earths sit on the table in Washington, and the outcome will say more about Western defence deliveries in 2027 than any budget vote this autumn.

Sources and update notes

Internal. Heyokha research Wiki, page *Defense* (type: theme; created 23 June 2026; last reviewed 19 August 2026; 9,658 words), sections Thesis, What would change it, Key players & instruments, Contradictions, "August 2026: Panic in the Pentagon? — the capability and credibility gap", "July 2026: record global spending and the minerals stranglehold", and the dated August–September 2026 update log. Provider issues relied upon: 13D WILTW 2 July 2026 (SIPRI $2.9tn, Defense Index +15.0% YTD and +600.4% since August 2016 inception); 13D WILTW 30 July 2026 (Rheinmetall's antimony and tungsten intensity, Chinese sanctions); 13D WILTW 6 August 2026 (Operation Rough Rider, stockpile depletion, the capability and credibility gap); 13D WATMTU 9 August 2026 and Gary Shilling Insight 1 August 2026 (munitions-shortage warnings); 13D WILTW 13 August 2026 (the caution against drone certainty, Arena-M, directed energy); 13D WATMTU 16 August 2026; 13D WILTW 27 August 2026 (the Defense Industrial Base Consortium conference, Anduril, minerals as the

bottleneck; Defense Index −6.0% on the week); 13D WILTW 3 September 2026 (sea drones, the Leidos addition, overseas bases; Defense Index −5.0% on the week). Related internal pages consulted for context: *critical-minerals*, *defense-tech*, *multipolar-world-order*.

Limitation on the internal view. This is the most provider-concentrated page in regular use. Of the thirty-five sources listed in the Defense page's frontmatter, thirty-four are 13D Research publications; the sole exception is a single Greed & Fear issue from March 2025. The page's Contradictions section is empty and says so explicitly: "None yet — only 13D sources in the compilation window." Its bear-case heading carries no text. Every internal judgement in this edition — the minerals-as-bottleneck framing, the capability gap, the caution on drones, the obsolescence of forward bases — therefore rests on one house's analytical framework, with no second internal opinion to check it. Readers should treat the internal material as a coherent single argument rather than as a consensus, and weight it accordingly. The external leg of this edition was gathered specifically to supply the counterweight the page does not contain.

External. (1) Rheinmetall AG half-yearly financial report, 6 August 2026: H1 revenue €5,227m against €3,749m, +39%; operating margin 12.1% to 15.0%; order backlog €80.5bn (Vehicle Systems €28.8bn, Weapon & Ammunition €25.3bn, Digital Systems €20.6bn, Naval €6.3bn, Air Defence €4.2bn); FY26 sales guidance €13.7–14.2bn against €9,935m in 2025; backlog coverage 95%; guidance trimmed roughly €300m on the F126 cancellation; Q2 book-to-bill above 3; backlog guided to €100–120bn by end-2026. (2) Rheinmetall share price €1,034.90, 7 September 2026; consensus twelve-month target €1,679 from 21 analysts. (3) Leidos Holdings Q2 FY2026 release and earnings call, 4 August 2026: record revenue $4.6bn, +7%; adjusted EBITDA margin 13.8%; non-GAAP diluted EPS $3.26, +2%; operating cash flow near $800m; $5bn net awards, book-to-bill 1.1; FY26 guidance raised to revenue $18.20–18.40bn, non-GAAP EPS $12.20–12.50, operating cash flow about $1.85bn. (4) Reuters, 4 September 2026: some Chinese rare-earth suppliers halting US shipments following Beijing's August sanctioning of the Responsible Business Alliance; gallium exports −65% and yttrium −98% year-to-date on Chinese customs data; rare-earth supply on the agenda for President Xi's 24 September Washington visit. (5) Trade reporting as of September 2026: Rotterdam ammonium paratungstate above $3,000/t, up more than 200% year-to-date; China at approximately 90% of rare-earth processing, 80% of tungsten refining and 60% of antimony production; fifteen Chinese firms licensed to export tungsten in 2026–27 under December 2025 rules; no active US commercial tungsten mine; defence roughly 12% of tungsten demand, rising toward 15% by 2027–28. (6) NATO defence investment update, July 2026: European allies and Canada at approximately $634bn in 2026, 2.53% of GDP, 42.7% of alliance spending against 30.3% in 2021; 5% of GDP target for 2035 (3.5% core, 1.5% related); five allies expected to meet 3.5% in 2026 and seventeen to meet 1.5%; Belgium +59% and Spain +50% year on year. (7) US 155mm artillery production reporting: approximately 40,000 rounds per month reported as of August 2025 against a near-term target of 70,000–80,000 and a stated goal of 100,000; NATO alliance-wide 2026 target 267,000 per month; approximately 66,000 tonnes of explosives required for 100,000 complete rounds monthly. (8) Market data as of 7 September 2026: iShares US Aerospace & Defense ETF (ITA) $225.61, 52-week range $194.63–$256.60; Lockheed Martin $526.23, up roughly 30% in 2026, consensus target $632.95 with a $503–$756 range; L3Harris 52-week range approximately $256.05–$379.23. (9) MP Materials $54.53 as of 5 September 2026, 52-week range $37.81–$100.25; Fort Worth Independence facility under development. (10) Hanwha Aerospace Q1 2026: consolidated sales KRW 5,751bn, +5%; operating profit KRW 638.9bn, +21%; Land Systems operating profit −31% on light Q1 export deliveries; Land Systems backlog approximately KRW 39,700bn including the Norway Chunmoo contract; Finland K9 award of about KRW 940bn expected in the Q2 backlog; market capitalisation approximately $42bn.

Editorial choices in this automated run. The topic was selected by scoring every entity appearing in Wiki source summaries published since 18 August 2026 — three points for the last three days, two within seven, one within twenty-one, plus three for appearing in a source title — and ranking eligible active themes against a thirty-day no-repeat rule. The archive folder was read directly from the connected desktop folder rather than through the remote-devices bridge, which was not required; thirty-eight files were parsed and twenty-five prior editions dated between 10 August and 7 September 2026 were placed on cooldown. Defense scored 12, behind Gold (24, on cooldown from 26 August), AI Capex (18) and Gold Miners (14). AI Capex and Gold Miners were skipped: the task specification names their most recent editions as ones to treat as recent, AI Capex has already run four times in this archive, and the adjacent AI Debt Financing edition ran on 3 September. Defense was therefore taken as the highest-scoring theme with no adjacent recent edition; it has never been the subject of a Field Guide, and it drew its score from being named in two source titles in the past twelve days. Two tool notes. First, the Wiki's list_pages response exceeded the token limit and was parsed from disk rather than read whole, as intended. Second, the internal Defense page returned an empty bear-case section and an explicitly empty Contradictions section, so the sceptical case was constructed from external reporting and from internal tensions, as stated in the body. No figure that could not be verified externally has been carried into the tiles, the figure band or the bar chart.
